

Body hair

The body is covered with millions of hairs. Thick terminal hairs, such as those of the scalp and eyebrows, help to protect the body. Shorter, finer vellus hairs cover much of the rest of the body.

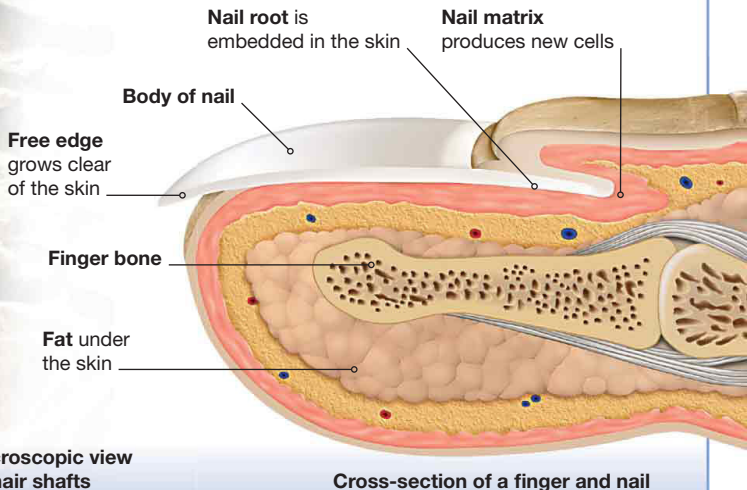
Terminal hair

Vellus hair



Protective nails

Each nail has a root and a body, and ends in a free edge. In the nail matrix behind the root, living cells multiply and push the nail body forward to make the nail grow. Most nails grow about $\frac{1}{100}$ in (0.3 mm) each week.



Microscopic view of hair shafts

Cross-section of a finger and nail